

Word family: **deal / deals / dealt / dealing / dealer**

Base word: deal

Past tense: dealt

Past participle: dealt

ing form: dealing

Related form: dealer

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “On the surface, that may sound simple, but in reality it shaped the way I **deal with** pressure, mistakes, and even other people.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **deal with** means to **handle, manage, or respond to a situation, problem, person, or difficulty**.

繁體中文： **處理、應付或面對某個問題、情況、壓力或人物**

中文翻譯：

> “...it shaped the way I **deal with** pressure, mistakes, and even other people.”

「.....它深深影響了我如何**面對 / 處理**壓力、錯誤，甚至如何對待別人。」

Here:

deal with pressure = 應付 / 處理壓力

Because **deal with** is essential to the exact target sentence, it should be included despite the usual phrasal-verb exclusion. The Manual explicitly allows that exception when the phrasal verb is necessary for the target usage.

1. **deal with = handle/manage (處理) — 處理；應付；面對**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To take action about a problem, situation, task, or person and manage it appropriately.

Practice 1 — Original

> “It shaped the way I **deal with** pressure and mistakes.”

「它影響了我如何**面對 / 處理**壓力和錯誤。」

Practice 2

> “She is good at **dealing with** difficult situations.”

「她很擅長**處理**困難情況。」

Practice 3

> “We need to **deal with** this problem before it gets worse.”

「我們需要在問題惡化之前**處理**它。」

deal with something = 採取適當方法處理、管理或應付某個情況 / 問題

2. **deal with** = interact with / handle people (對待 / 打交道) — 與.....打交道 ; 對待

Deal with can also refer specifically to how someone interacts with other people.

Practice 4

> “He knows how to **deal with** angry customers.”

「他知道如何**應付 / 與憤怒的顧客打交道**。」

Practice 5

> “Teachers often have to **deal with** many different personalities.”

「老師經常要**面對 / 應付**很多不同性格的人。」

deal with someone = 與某人互動、應付某人，或處理與某人的關係

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1 because the core idea remains **handling/managing**.

3. **deal with** = be about / discuss a subject (內容) — 涉及 ; 討論 ; 處理某主題

A book, article, film, speech, course, etc. can **deal with** a topic.

Practice 6

> “The book **deals with** childhood and memory.”

「這本書**探討 / 涉及**童年和記憶。」

Practice 7

> “The report **deals with** several environmental issues.”

「這份報告**討論 / 處理**幾個環境議題。」

****deal with a subject = 以某個主題為內容，對它進行討論、分析或探討****

This is a distinct learner-use of the same phrasal verb.

4. ****deal = distribute cards (牌類遊戲) — 發牌****

As a bare verb, ****deal**** can mean to distribute playing cards to players.

Practice 8

> “It’s your turn to ****deal****.”

「輪到你****發牌****了。」

Practice 9

> “She ****dealt**** five cards to each player.”

「她給每位玩家****發了五張牌****。」

****deal cards = 把牌分發給各位玩家****

This is a genuinely distinct core meaning.

5. ****deal = distribute/give out something (分發) — 分派；分發****

The card sense can extend to distributing other things, though this is much less general than ordinary ****give out****.

Practice 10

> “The cards were ****dealt**** evenly.”

「牌被平均****分發****。」

Practice 11

> “Fate had ****dealt**** him a difficult hand.”

「命運給了他一副艱難的牌局；比喻他的人生處境很困難。」

The figurative pattern:

> ****be dealt a bad/difficult hand****

means to be given difficult circumstances by life.

For core counting, I would keep this under the card/distribution branch.

6. ****deal = trade / do business (商業) — 經營；交易****

As a verb, ****deal**** can mean to buy and sell goods or conduct business.

Practice 12

> “The company ****deals**** in office furniture.”

「這家公司****經營 / 買賣****辦公室家具。」

Practice 13

> “They ****deal**** directly with overseas suppliers.”

「他們直接與海外供應商****做生意 / 交易****。」

****deal in something = 經營、買賣某類商品****

****deal with someone commercially = 與某人進行商業往來****

This is distinct from “handle a problem.”

7. **deal = agreement/business arrangement (名詞) — 交易 ; 協議**

As a noun, **a deal** can mean an agreement or arrangement between people, companies, or organizations.

Practice 14

> “They reached a **deal** after several hours of discussion.”

「他們經過幾小時討論後達成了**協議**。」

Practice 15

> “The two companies signed a major business **deal**.”

「兩家公司簽署了一項大型商業**交易 / 協議**。」

a deal = 雙方或多方達成的商業、財務或其他安排 / 協議

This is a major noun meaning.

8. **deal = bargain / favourable purchase (划算交易) — 划算的買賣 ; 優惠**

A **deal** can also mean a good bargain.

Practice 16

> “That laptop was a great **deal**.”

「那部手提電腦買得很**划算**。」

Practice 17

> “The hotel is offering a special **deal** this weekend.”

「酒店這個週末提供特別**優惠**。」

a good/special deal = 價格、條件或優惠非常有利的交易 / 安排

This develops from the agreement/transaction sense.

For core counting, I would merge it with Meaning 7.

9. **deal = amount / degree (大量) — 很多 ; 大量**

In expressions such as **a great deal**, **deal** means a large amount or degree.

Practice 18

> “She learned a great **deal** from the experience.”

「她從那次經歷中學到了**很多**。」

Practice 19

> “The change caused a good **deal** of confusion.”

「這項改變造成了**很多**混亂。」

a great/good deal = 很多 ; 大量

This is a fixed quantity expression and is common enough to flag, though I would not make it a separate bare-word core meaning.

10. **deal = treatment received (待遇) — 待遇**

In fixed combinations, **deal** can mean the treatment or conditions someone receives.

Practice 20

> “Everyone deserves a fair **deal**.”

「每個人都值得得到**公平待遇**。」

Practice 21

> “Workers were demanding a better **deal**.”

「工人要求更好的**待遇 / 條件**。」

a fair/better deal = 某人所得到的待遇、條件或安排

This grows from the **agreement/arrangement** sense and does not need a separate core category.

Related form: **dealer**

A **dealer** is a person or company that buys and sells a particular kind of product.

Practice 22

> “He works for a car **dealer**.”

「他在一間汽車**經銷商**工作。」

Practice 23

> “The gallery contacted an art **dealer**.”

「畫廊聯絡了一名藝術品**商人 / 經銷商**。」

****dealer = 專門買賣某類商品的人或公司****

This belongs to the business branch of ****deal****.

Important distinction: ****deal with vs handle****

****deal with****

is broad and natural for:

- * problems
- * situations
- * people
- * topics

****handle****

often emphasizes managing something effectively or practically.

- > deal with pressure
- > handle pressure

Both are natural.

But:

> “The book deals with history.”

works.

> “The book handles history.”

is possible but much less neutral.

Important distinction: ****deal with vs solve****

****deal with****

means take action to manage or respond to a problem.

****solve****

means actually find the answer or remove the problem.

You can:

> deal with a problem

without completely:

> solving it.

This is especially important in your passage.

Important distinction: ****deal vs trade****

****trade****

focuses on buying/selling or exchanging goods/assets.

****deal****

can mean commercial activity, but also:

* an agreement

* cards

* handling a situation

* a bargain

So **deal** is much broader.

Important distinction: **deal** vs **agreement**

agreement

means the agreed terms or understanding between parties.

deal

is more conversational and often implies negotiation or exchange.

> “They reached an agreement.”

more neutral/formal.

> “They made a deal.”

more conversational/commercial.

Important distinction: **deal** vs **bargain**

deal

= a transaction or agreement generally.

bargain

= something obtained at an unusually good price.

So:

> “It was a good deal.”

may mean favourable terms.

> “It was a bargain.”

strongly emphasizes low price/value.

Useful expression: **a great deal — 很多**

Practice 24

> “He has changed a great **deal**.”

「他改變了**很多**。」

Practice 25

> “We spent a great **deal** of time on the project.”

「我們在這個項目上花了**很多**時間。」

Useful expression: **big deal — 大不了的事 / 重要的事情**

Practice 26

> “It’s not a big **deal**.”

「這不是甚麼**大不了的事**。」

Practice 27

> “Winning the award was a big **deal** for her.”

「獲獎對她來說是件**很重要的事**。」

big deal can be literal/evaluative, and in informal speech can also be sarcastic.

I would treat it as a fixed expression, not a core lexical sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **deal**

* **deals**

* **dealt**

* **dealing**

* **dealer**

Useful constructions include:

- * deal with a problem
- * deal with people
- * deal with a topic
- * deal cards
- * deal in goods
- * business deal
- * good deal
- * fair deal
- * a great deal
- * big deal

The Golden Manual requires a broad pass over grammatical constructions and fixed expressions, but also warns against turning every collocation into a separate sense.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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deal with — handle/manage	處理、應付或面對某個問題、情況、壓力或人物
deal with — be about/discuss	某書籍、文章、報告等涉及、討論或探討某個主題
deal — distribute cards	把牌分發給玩家
deal — trade/do business	經營、買賣某類商品或與某人進行商業往來
a deal — agreement/transaction	雙方或多方達成的商業、財務或其他協議 / 安排
a good deal — bargain	條件或價格有利、很划算的交易；與 transaction 義相關
a great deal	很多；大量；固定數量表達
dealer	專門買賣某類商品的人或公司

For your original sentence

> “...it shaped the way I **deal with** pressure, mistakes, and even other people.”

The exact meaning is:

deal with = 面對某種情況並採取適當方式處理或應付

So:

> **deal with pressure**

= **應付 / 處理壓力**

> **deal with mistakes**

= **處理 / 面對錯誤**

> **deal with other people**

= **與別人相處 / 打交道**

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** for **deal**:

1. **deal with — handle/manage a situation, problem, or person**
2. **deal with — concern/discuss a subject**
3. **deal — distribute cards**
4. **deal — conduct business / trade**
5. **noun — agreement or transaction**

I would merge **good deal / fair deal** into #5 as transaction/arrangement extensions, keep **a great deal** and **big deal** as fixed expressions, and include **deal with** here because it is essential to the exact sentence despite the default phrasal-verb exclusion.